casting for the SLV inertial guidance platform. Taking it as a personal chal enge, Dr Arunachalam had the investment casting, the first of its kind in the country, made in the incredibly short time of two months. His youthful energy and enthusiasm never failed to amaze me. This young metal urgist had within a short span of time lifted the science of metal-making to the technology of metal-forming and then to the art of al oy development. With a tal and elegant figure, Dr Arunachalam was like an electrical y charged dynamo himself. I found him an unusual y friendly person with a forceful manner, as wel as an excel ent working partner.

I visited DRDL in April 1982 to acquaint myself with my potential work site. The Director of DRDL then, SL Bansal, took me around and introduced me to the senior scientists in the laboratory. DRDL was working on five staff projects and sixteen competence build-up projects. They were also involved in several technology-oriented activities with a view to gain lead time for the development of indigenous missile systems in future. I was particularly impressed by their efforts on the twin 30-ton Liquid Propel ant Rocket Engine.